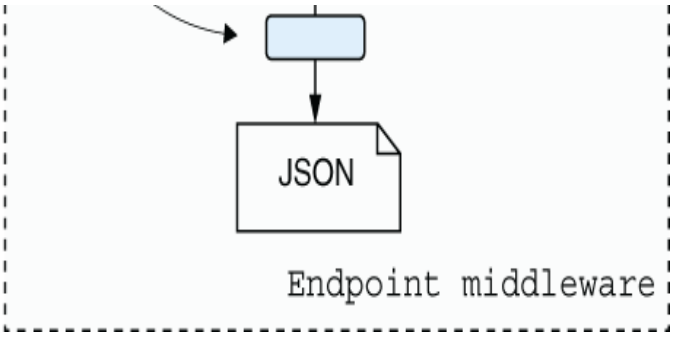


Figure 21.1 Filters run at multiple points in the `EndpointMiddleware` as part of the normal handling of an MVC request. A similar pipeline exists for Razor Page requests.

Without filters, you'd need to include the same code to check for a logged-in user at the start of each specific action method. With this approach, the MVC framework would still execute the model binding and validation, even if the user were not logged in.

With filters, you can use the *hooks* in the MVC request to run common code across all requests or a subset of requests. This way you can do a wide range of things, such as

- Ensure that a user is logged in before an action method, model binding, or validation runs.
- Customize the output format of particular action methods.
- Handle model validation failures before an action method is invoked.
- Catch exceptions from an action method and handle them in a special way.

In many ways, the MVC filter pipeline is like an extra middleware pipeline, restricted to MVC and Razor Pages requests only. Like middleware, filters